"I'm helpless."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

When a body or mind limits what we can do, tasks that were easy become hard and we depend on others. Over time, "I need help with some things" can become "I am helpless."

What Scripture teaches

"God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble." "The LORD is my helper; I will not be afraid." "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength." Even when we need much help from others, we still have prayer, love, wisdom, and presence to give, and we are never helpless before God: "You hold my right hand." Dependence is part of how God made us all.

> *"So we say with confidence: 'The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?'"* (Hebrews 13:6).

Also see

> "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble" (Psalm 46:1).

> "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength" (Philippians 4:13).

> "Yet I am always with You; You hold my right hand" (Psalm 73:23).

> "Do not fear, for I am with you; do not be afraid, for I am your God. I will strengthen you; I will surely help you; I will uphold you with My right hand of righteousness" (Isaiah 41:10).

Common self-statements

- I cannot do anything.
- I am useless.
- I depend on everyone.
- I have no power.
- I am trapped.
- I cannot help myself.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either independent or helpless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be capable.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling dependent and concluding that I am helpless.
- Labeling: Calling myself helpless.

Challenging questions

- What can I still do, even if differently?
- What aids or adaptations could increase my independence?
- What can I give to others?
- What does God say about helping those who depend on Him?

- Who helps me, and what do they receive from helping?
- What is one task I can reclaim?

Truth summary

> I am not helpless. I can do many things, in my own way and with help. God is my helper, and I have much to give.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Weakness
- Trust
- Hopeless
- Humility
- Sickness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm helpless"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm helpless." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What can I still do, even if differently?
- ☐ What aids or adaptations could increase my independence?
- ☐ What can I give to others?
- ☐ What does God say about helping those who depend on Him?
- ☐ Who helps me, and what do they receive from helping?
- ☐ What is one task I can reclaim?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord is my helper.
- ☐ God is my refuge and strength.
- ☐ I can do all things through Christ.
- ☐ God holds my right hand.
- ☐ I can still give.
- ☐ Help is not weakness.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Hebrews 13:6**
  "So we say with confidence: 'The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?'"
- ☐ **Psalm 46:1**
  "God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in times of trouble."
- ☐ **Philippians 4:13**
  "I can do all things through Christ who gives me strength."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] What I can do: Each week, note one thing you did yourself and one thing you gave.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Hebrews 13:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord is my helper.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List abilities. Write what you can do.
- [ ] Try adaptive tools. Ask an occupational therapist.
- [ ] Give something. Pray, call, or listen.
- [ ] Memorize Hebrews 13:6. Say it when you feel helpless.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm helpless": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	What I can do
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm helpless.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel helpless. You are my helper. Show me what I can still do, send practical help, and let me give from where I am. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #42 · DISABILITY AND IMPAIRMENT

"I'm less of a man (or woman) because of this."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Disability can challenge roles as provider, protector, caregiver, or athlete. Society's images of strength can make us feel less masculine or feminine, especially when injury or illness changes how we work, parent, or relate.

What Scripture teaches

"God created man in His own image… male and female He created them." Your identity as a man or woman in God's image does not depend on strength or ability. "The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor." "My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness." "When I am weak, then I am strong." Courage, love, faithfulness, and character are the real marks of maturity.

> *"So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them"* (Genesis 1:27).

Also see

> "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable" (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me" (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well" (Psalm 139:14).

> "But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong" (1 Corinthians 1:27).

Common self-statements

- I cannot be what I should be.
- I have lost my role.
- A real man (or woman) would not need this.
- I am less than before.
- I have failed my family.
- I am not enough.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either fully a man or woman or less.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that others will see me as less.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling diminished and concluding that I am.
- Labeling: Calling myself less.

Challenging questions

- What does manhood or womanhood mean to me, and where did I learn it?
- What qualities of character do I still show?

- How do my loved ones see me?
- What roles can I fulfill differently?
- What does Scripture say about identity and weakness?
- What new role might God give me?

Truth summary

> My identity as a man or woman is a gift from God, not a measure of strength. I can serve my family and others in new ways, with courage and character.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Weakness
- Pride
- God, Creator
- Humility

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "I'm less of a man (or woman) because of this"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm less of a man (or woman) because of this." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does manhood or womanhood mean to me, and where did I learn it?
- ☐ What qualities of character do I still show?
- ☐ How do my loved ones see me?
- ☐ What roles can I fulfill differently?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about identity and weakness?
- ☐ What new role might God give me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ Weaker parts are honored.
- ☐ God's grace is sufficient.
- ☐ In weakness I am strong.
- ☐ My character matters most.
- ☐ I can serve differently.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Genesis 1:27
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] New ways to serve: Each week, note one way you served or loved.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Genesis 1:27 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I am made in God's image, and my worth is not my strength.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Weakness" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Name the roles. Write what you have lost and what remains.
- [ ] Ask your family. Hear how they see you.
- [ ] Find a new role. Mentoring, listening, praying.
- [ ] Read 2 Corinthians 12:9. Rest in His power.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm less of a man (or woman) because of this": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	New ways to serve
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm less of a man (or woman) because of this.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I feel diminished. Remind me that I am Your image-bearer, and show me how to love and serve in my new circumstances. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #43 · DISABILITY AND IMPAIRMENT

“If I can't be independent, I have no dignity.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Needing help with dressing, bathing, eating, or finances can feel humiliating. A culture that prizes independence can make dependence seem shameful.

What Scripture teaches

Dignity comes from God: “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor” (Psalm 8:5). Jesus washed His disciples’ feet and told them to serve one another. “The parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor.” “Carry one another’s burdens.” Dignity is a gift of creation and redemption, not of independence. Receiving care graciously honors both giver and receiver.

> *“You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor”* (Psalm 8:5).

Also see

> “On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor. And our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty, whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God has composed the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it” (1 Corinthians 12:22–24).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “Even to your old age, I will be the same, and I will bear you up when you turn gray. I have made you, and I will carry you; I will sustain you and deliver you” (Isaiah 46:4).

Common self-statements

- I am humiliated by needing help.
- I have lost my dignity.
- Being cared for makes me small.
- I am a child again.
- I hate being dependent.
- I am diminished.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either independent or undignified.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will lose all respect.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling embarrassed and concluding that I have no dignity.
- Labeling: Calling myself undignified.

Challenging questions

- What does dignity mean to me, and where did I learn it?
- How do I treat others who need help?
- How does God see people who need care?
- What choices do I still make for myself?
- How can I direct my care with respect?
- What can I offer those who help me?

Truth summary

> My dignity comes from God, who crowned me with glory and honor. Needing help does not remove it. I can direct my care, accept help graciously, and give thanks.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Humility
- Pride
- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Weakness

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I can't be independent, I have no dignity"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I can't be independent, I have no dignity." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does dignity mean to me, and where did I learn it?
- ☐ How do I treat others who need help?
- ☐ How does God see people who need care?
- ☐ What choices do I still make for myself?
- ☐ How can I direct my care with respect?
- ☐ What can I offer those who help me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God crowned me with glory and honor.
- ☐ Weaker parts are given greater honor.
- ☐ We carry one another's burdens.
- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ I can direct my care.
- ☐ Receiving is a gift.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 8:5
  "You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor."
- ☐ 1 Corinthians 12:22–24
  "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable, and the parts we consider less honorable, we treat with greater honor. And our unpresentable parts are treated with special modesty, whereas our presentable parts have no such need. But God has composed the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it."
- ☐ Galatians 6:2
  "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Dignity intact: Each week, note one choice you made about your own care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 8:5 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God crowned me with glory and honor.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Humility" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your choices. Write what you can decide.
- [ ] Speak up. Tell caregivers how you prefer help.
- [ ] Say thanks. Let helpers know it matters.
- [ ] Read Psalm 8. Remember your crown.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I can't be independent, I have no dignity": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Dignity intact
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I can't be independent, I have no dignity.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I struggle with needing help. Remind me that You crowned me with glory and honor, and help me receive care with grace. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #44 · DISABILITY AND IMPAIRMENT

"I'm always in the way."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Wheelchairs, walkers, slow movement, and special needs can make us feel obstructive in crowded places, in families, and in plans. Sighs, glances, and inaccessible spaces reinforce this.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus welcomed the disabled and the marginalized. He said to invite "the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind," and Scripture shows people making room for them. "God settles the lonely in families." "Each member belongs to one another." Inaccessible spaces are failures of the community, not of you. God's people are called to make room. You belong, and you can say what you need.

> *"But when you host a banquet, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind"* (Luke 14:13).

Also see

> "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land" (Psalm 68:6).

> "So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another" (Romans 12:5).

> "On the contrary, the parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable" (1 Corinthians 12:22).

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- I am a nuisance.
- Everything has to change for me.
- I slow everyone down.
- I should stay home.
- People wish I were not here.
- I take up too much space.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I either fit in perfectly or I am in the way.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be an obstacle.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling awkward and concluding that I am unwelcome.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a nuisance.

Challenging questions

- Who welcomes me without fuss?
- What places or groups are accessible and kind?
- What do I need in order to participate, and can I ask for it?
- What does Scripture say about those with disabilities?

- How do I feel when someone else asks for help?
- What gifts do I bring to a gathering?

Truth summary

> I belong. God places the lonely in families, and Jesus welcomes everyone. I can ask for what I need, choose welcoming places, and offer my gifts.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Loneliness
- Church
- Friendship
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love, For Others

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I'm always in the way"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I'm always in the way." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who welcomes me without fuss?
- ☐ What places or groups are accessible and kind?
- ☐ What do I need in order to participate, and can I ask for it?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about those with disabilities?
- ☐ How do I feel when someone else asks for help?
- ☐ What gifts do I bring to a gathering?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God settles the lonely in families.
- ☐ Jesus welcomes all.
- ☐ I belong to the body.
- ☐ I can ask for what I need.
- ☐ Barriers are not my fault.
- ☐ I have gifts to bring.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Luke 14:13
  "But when you host a banquet, invite the poor, the crippled, the lame, and the blind."
- ☐ Psalm 68:6
  "God settles the lonely in families; He leads the prisoners out to prosperity, but the rebellious dwell in a sun-scorched land."
- ☐ Romans 12:5
  "So in Christ we who are many are one body, and each member belongs to one another."

A verse I found myself: _____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ I belong: Each week, note one place or person where you felt welcome.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 14:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God settles the lonely in families, and I belong.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Loneliness" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ List welcoming places. Write where you feel at ease.
- ☐ Ask for accommodations. Make a clear request.
- ☐ Share a gift. Offer something to a group.
- ☐ Read Luke 14:13. Notice who Jesus invites.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I'm always in the way": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	I belong
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I'm always in the way.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel in the way. Thank You that You welcome everyone. Lead me to people who make room and use my gifts among them. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

“People only feel sorry for me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Pity can feel patronizing: a head tilt, extra helpfulness, lowered expectations. Over time, we may shut out all kindness to avoid being pitied.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus had compassion and also treated people as full persons: “Do you want to get well?” (John 5:6), He asked, and He said, “Get up, pick up your mat, and walk.” Peter said to the lame man, “What I have I give you,” and then took him by the right hand. Compassion and respect go together. Not everyone gets it right, but many act from love. “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep.” You can invite people to relate as equals.

> *“But Peter said, ‘Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!’”* (Acts 3:6).

Also see

> “When Jesus saw him lying there and realized that he had spent a long time in this condition, He asked him, ‘Do you want to get well?’” (John 5:6).

> “Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep” (Romans 12:15).

> “For we do not have a high priest who is unable to sympathize with our weaknesses, but we have one who was tempted in every way that we are, yet was without sin” (Hebrews 4:15).

> “Carry one another’s burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ” (Galatians 6:2).

Common self-statements

- They see me as a charity case.
- They think I am pathetic.
- Nobody respects me.
- Kindness is just pity.
- They do not see me.
- I do not want sympathy.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either respect me or pity me.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will see only my condition.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling pitied and concluding I am not respected.
- Mind reading: Calling myself a charity case.

Challenging questions

- Who treats me as an equal?
- What do I want people to see?
- How can I invite a different kind of relationship?

- What do I give back in friendship?
- What did Jesus' and Peter's example show about compassion and respect?
- What is one conversation where I could be more direct?

Truth summary

> People's kindness can come from love, and I can invite respect by sharing what I want them to see. Jesus shows compassion that respects, and I can look for friendships of equals.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Friendship
- Pride
- Humility
- Love, For Others
- Self-Esteem, Low

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People only feel sorry for me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People only feel sorry for me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who treats me as an equal?
- ☐ What do I want people to see?
- ☐ How can I invite a different kind of relationship?
- ☐ What do I give back in friendship?
- ☐ What did Jesus' and Peter's example show about compassion and respect?
- ☐ What is one conversation where I could be more direct?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Compassion and respect go together.
- ☐ Jesus treated people as whole persons.
- ☐ I can invite respect.
- ☐ I give as well as receive.
- ☐ Many act from love.
- ☐ I can speak up.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Acts 3:6
  "But Peter said, 'Silver or gold I do not have, but what I have I give you: In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!'"
- ☐ John 5:6
  "When Jesus saw him lying there and realized that he had spent a long time in this condition, He asked him, 'Do you want to get well?'"
- ☐ Romans 12:15
  "Rejoice with those who rejoice; weep with those who weep."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

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PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Seen and respected: Each week, note one interaction where you felt respected.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Acts 3:6 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Compassion and respect go together.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
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6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

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- ☐ List respectful people. Write who treats you as an equal.
- ☐ Say what you want. Tell a friend how to help.
- ☐ Give back. Encourage, pray for, or listen to others.
- ☐ Read John 5:1–9. Notice Jesus' question.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People only feel sorry for me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Seen and respected
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Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
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Tue		
Wed		
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Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People only feel sorry for me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I want to be seen, not pitied. Teach me to receive kindness and invite respect, and send friends who see all of me. Amen.

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